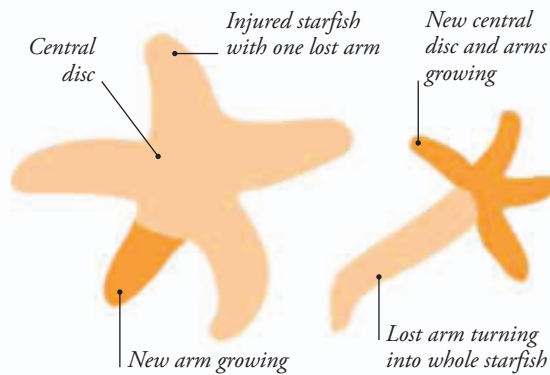


NEW FOR OLD

One of the most amazing things about starfish is the way they can grow new body parts if they are injured. A starfish can easily grow a new arm to replace a lost limb. If the lost limb still has part of the central disc attached, it will grow a whole new body. This means that if one starfish is sliced in two, it can survive, regrow the missing parts, and become two starfish.



STARRY SWARMS

Brittle stars are slender starfish with very flexible arms and small, circular central discs. They live on the seabed, where they use their mobile, spiny arms to crawl over the sand. These colorful starfish feed on small food particles that settle on the bottom. In places where the food supply is plentiful, they can form dense swarms—there can be as many as 2,000 brittle stars in 3 square feet (1 square meter).

SIFTING THE WATER

Feather stars are starfish with bodies that have become adapted to living upside down, firmly attached to rocks on the seabed. They feed on tiny plankton and edible particles drifting in the water, which they snare with the tube feet extending from their feathery arms.



WOW!

Starfish have lived in the oceans for at least 450 million years—long before the first dinosaurs roamed the land.

MUD SWALLOWERS

Sea cucumbers have elongated five-sided bodies, with a mouth and tentacles at one end. They live on the seabed, where they feed by swallowing the soft muddy sediment and digesting any edible material. If threatened, they squirt a sticky substance at their attacker.

